> affect their lives. Meaningful engagement increases the chances that a young person's views are heard, respected and utilised. This in turn leads to young people feeling more connected to and developing a stake in a collective larger than themselves. (pp. 102–3)

The opposite of engagement, that is, marginalization, can drive the youth towards militant ideologies that carry false promises of certainty and reward. The lack of education and employment means that many young people cannot afford to get married and raise a family. 'It is no coincidence that most of those involved in militant attacks are young men who feel disenfranchised in one way or another and have never had the opportunity to develop a sense of their own potential in shaping a better future for themselves, their families and communities' (p. 106).

The report is particularly valuable in that it engages with youth representatives from all sections of society. Much research on politics in Pakistan has focused on youth as 'students' (as in higher education) and student politics (such as Nasr 1992; Nelson 2009; Nelson 2011; see also Jinnah Institute 2013). The majority of young people in Pakistan will never finish their education and will have dropped out somewhere along the way. It is therefore important to keep in mind the issues of class and education. It is for this reason that this book includes a range of voices from students in low-income areas who are unlikely to ever join a higher education institution.

Powell (2014) has argued that across the world marginality is now being experienced in a new and somewhat distinctive way by younger people. Writing on the youth allows us to contrast views collected between generations. While many young people do not seem to see the relevance of the state and its structures, teachers, parents and grandparents who took part in the study believed in the role of the state. Overall they spoke of their deep disappointment as the state has abrogated its responsibilities. Older people described how the state should be responsible for basic services, and at the very least provide security, but they acknowledged that in contemporary Pakistan the state had become elusive and they had to rely on family networks and civil society.

The data and our research

Four big field studies between 2009 and 2018 provided the material for this book. In 2009 a mixed-method survey was administered to more than 1,300 respondents across three provinces and supplemented with focus groups and interviews at schools and universities across the country. Data was not